

# Stakeholders

## 1. Guest User

— browses events and views details without an account

## 2. Registered User

— books tickets, receives AI recommendations, reads review summaries, manages bookings

## 3. Theatre Management

— lists and manages movies, sets pricing and schedules, track sales

## 4. Concert Management

— lists and manages concerts, sets pricing and schedules, track sales

## 5. Shows Management

— lists and manages shows, sets pricing and schedules, track sales

## 6. Venue Management

— provides venue details, manages capacity, coordinates with organizers

## 7. Platform Admin

— oversees the entire platform, manages users and organizers, handles disputes, monitors system health

## 8. Customer Care Agent

— handles refund requests, booking issues, user complaints

## 9. Payment Gateway

(Razorpay / Stripe) — processes transactions, handles refunds

## 10. Review Aggregators

(IMDB / Rotten Tomatoes) — source of critic and audience review data fed into the GenAI summarizer

# Elicitation Techniques and Questions

The Elicitation Techniques and Questions for each stakeholders have been thought upon and finalised. Below are stakeholder-wise elicitation techniques and questions

## **1. Guest User**

Guest User Elicitation Techniques- **Questionnaire, Interviews & Observation.**

Observation can be done for guests- as in why do they stay as guests. What benefits do they obtain from browsing without logging in.

1. Browse the time and price of shows just to plan their day without logging in.
2. Look at reviews and decide whether to go for the show.
3. Scroll through the app to browse upcoming featured events.

No interviews for guest users because they haven't committed to the app fully, why would they give efforts in an interview?

Surveys can still be taken.

### **Guest User — Final Survey Questions**

#### **Section 1 — Browsing Behavior**

1. How often do you visit event ticketing websites like BookMyShow or Paytm Insider?
2. What is usually your intent when you visit? (Just browsing / Looking for something specific / Comparing options across platforms)
3. Which device do you primarily use to browse events? (Mobile / Desktop / Tablet)
4. How many platforms do you typically check before deciding where to book?

#### **Section 2 — Information Priority**

5. When you land on an event page, what is the first thing you look for? (Price / Timing / Venue / Cast or Lineup / Reviews / Seat availability)
6. Which of the following would make you immediately leave an event page? (No pricing visible / Unclear timing / Bad reviews / Venue too far / No seat map shown)

7. How important are reviews and ratings in your decision to attend an event?  
(Scale 1–5)

8. Would an AI-generated summary of critic and audience opinions help you decide faster than reading individual reviews?

### **Section 3 — Login Friction**

9. Have you ever abandoned a booking because you were asked to create an account first?

10. At what point would you be willing to log in or register? (Before browsing / Before seeing prices / Only when actually booking / Never)

11. Would you use a "Continue as Guest" option even if it meant no booking history was saved?

12. Have you ever chosen one platform over another simply because it required less login effort?

### **Section 4 — Discovery**

13. How do you currently discover events you want to attend? (Social media / Friends / Word of mouth / Browsing the platform / Notifications / Other)

14. Would you find a "Trending in your city" section useful without needing to log in?

15. Does seeing personalized recommendations (which require login) motivate you to create an account?

### **Section 5 — Pain Points**

16. What frustrates you most when browsing a ticketing site without an account?

17. Is there any information you typically struggle to find on these platforms?

18. Is there a feature you wish existed that no ticketing platform currently offers?

### **Guest User — Final Observation Checklist**

#### **Homepage Behavior**

- Where does the user look first — search bar, featured banners, or category tabs?

- Do they notice and use the city selector immediately, or do they see irrelevant events first?
- Do they interact with trending or featured sections or ignore them entirely?

### **Search and Filter Behavior**

- If they search, do they type the event name, a genre, or a city?
- On the listing page, which filter do they reach for first — date, price, language, or venue?
- Do they sort results? By what — popularity, price, or date?
- Do they open multiple events in separate tabs to compare?

### **Event Detail Page Behavior**

- What do they look at first — poster, price, timing, cast, or venue?
- Do they read the event description or skip it?
- How long do they spend on this page before deciding to proceed or go back?

### **At the Login Wall (when they click Book Now)**

- Do they proceed to register, switch to a different platform, or abandon entirely?
- Do they try logging in with Google or prefer email/password or Mobile number?

### **Navigation and Overall Flow**

- Do they ever look for something and visibly not find it — hovering, scrolling back up, looking confused?

## **2. Registered User**

For Registered users

Observation can be done but interviews will give a more thorough insight than observation.

Surveys are also required to get specific data.

### **Registered User - Survey Questions**

## **Section 1 — Booking Behavior**

1. How frequently do you book tickets through online platforms?
2. How far in advance do you typically book tickets?
3. Do you usually book alone or in a group?

## **Section 2 — Recommendations**

5. Do you find the event recommendations shown to you on ticketing platforms relevant to your taste?
6. What factor matters most in a recommendation? (Genre / Artist / Price / Location / Friends attending)
7. Have you ever attended an event purely because the platform recommended it?
8. Would you actively set your preferences (favourite genres, artists, cities) if it meant better recommendations?

## **Section 3 — Review and Decision Making**

9. Do you read reviews before booking a ticket?
10. Do you trust critic reviews, audience reviews, or both equally?
11. Would an AI-generated summary of all reviews help you decide faster?

## **Section 4 — Booking Flow**

13. Have you ever dropped off during the seat selection or payment process? If yes, why?
14. How satisfied are you with the current seat selection experience on platforms you use?
15. Have you ever faced a situation where a seat showed available but was already taken at payment?
16. Do you prefer receiving your ticket via email, SMS, or in-app?

## **Section 5 — Post-Booking**

17. Have you ever tried to cancel a booking? How was that experience?
19. Would you find event reminders (1 day before, 2 hours before) useful?
20. Have you ever reviewed or rated an event after attending?

Hari Sharma [11:49 PM]

## **Registered User — Interview Questions**

*(For depth — conducted with 5–8 individuals one-on-one)*

### **Opening — Understanding Context**

1. Tell me about the last event you booked online. Walk me through the entire experience from the moment you decided to go.
2. Which platform did you use and why that one specifically over others?
3. How did you find out about that event in the first place?

### **Discovery and Recommendations**

4. When you open a ticketing app without a specific event in mind, what do you do first?
5. Have you ever felt that the recommendations shown to you were completely off? What were they recommending and why did it feel wrong?
6. What would a perfect recommendation look like for you — what information would it show and how would it factor in your taste?
7. Do you follow any artists or venues on these platforms? Does that influence what you book?

### **Reviews and the Decision to Book**

10. If an AI gave you a 3-line summary of what critics and audiences are saying about an event, would you trust it enough to book without reading more?

### **Booking Flow**

11. Walk me through your last seat selection experience. What was easy, what was confusing?
12. Have you ever lost a seat between selecting it and completing payment? How did that feel and what did you do?
13. Is there anything about the checkout process on any platform that you find unnecessarily complicated?
14. How do you prefer to pay — UPI, card, net banking? Has a missing payment option ever stopped you from completing a booking?

## **Post-Booking and Account**

15. After booking, do you feel confident you have everything you need — ticket, venue details, directions? Or do you find yourself hunting for information?

16. Have you ever needed to cancel or modify a booking? Walk me through that experience.

18. Is there something you wish the platform would remind you of or notify you about that it currently doesn't?

## **Closing — Unmet Needs**

19. Is there a feature you've wanted on a ticketing platform that doesn't exist, or one thing you'd change about how you currently discover and book events?

## **3. Theatre Management**

### **1. Interview**

#### **Why use this technique:**

An interview will help us directly understand the responsibilities, requirements, problems, and expectations of the event/movie management stakeholder.

#### **Questions:**

1. Could you explain the complete process you follow when adding a new movie or event to the booking system?
2. What information do you require about a movie or event before making it available for customers?
3. How do you create and manage showtimes, and what factors do you consider while scheduling a show?
4. How do you manage theatres, screens, seating arrangements, and ticket prices for different shows?
5. What process do you follow when a show needs to be cancelled or rescheduled, especially when tickets have already been booked?
6. What booking, occupancy, and revenue information do you need to regularly monitor the performance of movies and shows?

7. What problems do you currently face while managing movies, shows, seats, or bookings, and what would you expect the new system to improve?

## **2. Document Analysis**

### **Why use this technique:**

Document analysis will help us identify the information, records, and business rules required by management by examining existing movie, show, theatre, seating, booking, and pricing records.

### **Questions:**

1. What information is currently recorded for each movie or event, and which details are essential for its management?
2. What information is included in the show schedule, such as date, time, theatre, and screen?
3. What information is maintained about theatres, screens, and their seating arrangements?
4. How are different seat categories and their corresponding ticket prices represented in the existing records?
5. What information is recorded for each booking, and which of these details are required by management?
6. What rules or procedures are documented for show cancellation, rescheduling, and booking cancellation?
7. What information is required in the existing booking, occupancy, and revenue reports?

## **3. Brainstorming**

### **Why use this technique:**

Brainstorming will help the project team generate additional requirements, identify possible problems, and consider exceptional situations that may not be identified through interviews and document analysis alone.

### **Questions:**

1. What features should the system provide to make movie and event management easier and more efficient?

2. What features should be available for creating, modifying, cancelling, and rescheduling shows?
3. How can the system prevent problems such as double booking of seats or scheduling conflicts between shows?
4. What should happen to existing bookings when a show is cancelled or rescheduled?
5. What information and statistics should be displayed on the management dashboard?
6. What reports would be most useful for analysing movie performance, ticket sales, occupancy, and revenue?
7. What access permissions and controls should be provided to different members of the movie/event management team?

#### **Why Other Elicitation Techniques Were Not Selected**

- **Survey:** Not selected because management requirements may require detailed explanations and follow-up questions.
- **Observation:** Not selected because direct access to the actual movie/event management workflow may not be available.

### **4. Concert Management**

#### **1. Interview → Event Managers**

##### **Why use this technique:**

An interview will help us understand the complete workflow followed by event managers while planning and managing live concerts. It will also help identify their problems, responsibilities, and expectations from the ticket booking system.

##### **Questions:**

1. Can you walk us through the process of organizing a concert from the initial planning stage until the event is completed?
2. What information do you need to enter when creating a new concert?

3. How do you manage the artist lineup, venue, date, time, and capacity of a concert?
4. How do you decide the different ticket categories and prices for an event?
5. How do you monitor ticket sales and the number of tickets remaining?
6. What problems do you face when a concert receives a very high number of booking requests?
7. What happens when a concert is postponed, cancelled, or its venue is changed?
8. What information would you like to see on an event management dashboard?
9. What reports do you need after a concert, such as ticket sales, attendance, or revenue?
10. What is the biggest problem in your current event-management process that you would like the new system to solve?

## **2. Questionnaire → Concert Attendees**

### **Why use this technique:**

A questionnaire will help us collect information from a larger number of concert attendees about how they discover concerts, select tickets, make bookings, make payments, and manage their tickets.

### **Section 1 — Concert Discovery**

1. How do you usually find out about concerts you are interested in attending?  
*(Social media / Friends / Ticketing apps / Artist websites / Advertisements / Other)*
2. How often do you attend live concerts?
3. What information do you look for first when viewing a concert?  
*(Artist / Date & time / Venue / Ticket price / Reviews / Other)*
4. How important are artist popularity and lineup when deciding whether to attend a concert?  
*(1–5)*

## **Section 2 — Ticket Selection**

1. Which type of ticket do you usually prefer?  
*(VIP / Premium / General / Standing / Depends on the event)*
2. How important is it to see ticket availability before starting a booking?
3. Would you prefer selecting a specific seat or simply selecting a ticket category?
4. What is the most important factor when choosing a ticket?  
*(Price / Location / View / Benefits / Availability)*

## **Section 3 — Booking and Payment**

1. Have you ever abandoned a concert booking because the booking process was too complicated?
2. What payment method do you prefer?  
*(UPI / Debit or Credit Card / Net Banking / Wallet / Other)*
3. Have you ever faced a situation where tickets appeared available but became unavailable while completing payment?
4. How would you prefer to receive your concert ticket?  
*(Email / SMS / Mobile app / Downloadable PDF)*

## **Section 4 — After Booking**

1. Would reminders before the concert be useful to you?
2. What information would you want to receive after booking?  
*(Ticket / Venue location / Entry instructions / Event timing / Artist information / Other)*
3. Have you ever needed to cancel a concert ticket? If yes, what problem did you face?
4. Would you like to receive notifications if the concert is postponed, cancelled, or the venue is changed?
5. What is one feature you would like to see in a concert ticket-booking system?

### **3. Observation → Existing Ticket-Booking Process**

#### **Why use this technique:**

Observation will help us understand how users actually interact with existing ticket-booking platforms and identify difficulties that users may not mention in interviews or questionnaires.

#### **Observation Checklist:**

##### **Event Discovery**

- Where does the user look first when opening the ticket-booking platform?
- Do they search directly for an artist/concert or browse available events?
- Which information do they check before opening an event?
- Do they use filters such as date, location, price, or event category?

##### **Concert Details**

- What information does the user look for first on the concert page?
- Do they check the venue location and event timing?
- Do they look for ticket availability and pricing?
- Do they read the event description or skip it?

##### **Ticket Selection**

- Does the user understand the different ticket categories?
- Do they have difficulty selecting seats or ticket types?
- Do they compare different ticket categories before proceeding?
- Do they notice additional booking fees or charges?

##### **Checkout**

- How easily does the user move from ticket selection to payment?
- Do they hesitate when entering personal or payment information?
- Do they encounter any confusing steps?
- What happens if a selected ticket becomes unavailable?

## **Post-Booking**

- Does the user easily find their ticket after payment?
- Can they find venue directions and event timing?
- Do they look for cancellation/refund information?
- Do they understand how the ticket will be used at the concert entrance?

## **4. Prototyping → Both Managers and Customers**

### **Why use this technique:**

Prototyping will allow us to create an early version of the system and obtain feedback from both event managers and concert attendees before implementing the complete system.

### **Prototype for Event Managers**

Show the manager screens such as:

- Create Concert
- Manage Artists
- Manage Venue
- Create Ticket Categories
- Set Ticket Prices
- View Ticket Availability
- Monitor Bookings
- Manage Cancellation/Postponement
- View Sales and Revenue Dashboard

### **Questions for Managers:**

1. Is all the required information available when creating a concert?
2. Is the process of creating ticket categories and prices easy to understand?
3. Does the dashboard show the information you need?
4. Would you change or add anything to the event-management workflow?

5. Can you easily understand the ticket sales and availability information?

### **Prototype for Concert Attendees**

Show the customer screens such as:

- Browse Concerts
- Search and Filter
- Concert Details
- Artist/Lineup
- Venue Information
- Ticket Selection
- Checkout
- Payment
- Digital Ticket / QR Code
- Booking History

### **Questions for Customers:**

1. Can you easily find the concert you are looking for?
2. Is the concert information clear before making a booking?
3. Is it easy to understand the different ticket categories and prices?
4. Is the ticket-selection process easy to use?
5. Is there any information you would want to see before paying?
6. Is the booking confirmation and digital ticket easy to understand?
7. What would you change or add to the prototype?

### **5. Show Management**

Interviews will give a far deeper insight than a plain survey here, since this is a small, high-value, expert stakeholder group with specialized workflow knowledge — pricing logic, artist/performer coordination, venue negotiation, settlement — that won't surface through a form alone.

Observation is not really practical for this stakeholder because most of their real work (contracts, artist calls, revenue splits) happens outside the platform, not inside an app screen.

Surveys are still useful here — to scale the patterns found in interviews across more organizers (different show types, sizes, experience levels) without needing to schedule everyone individually.

Event Organizer / Promoter — Survey Questions (Shows only)

### **Section 1 — Background**

1. What type(s) of shows do you typically organize? (Stand-up comedy / Theatre-drama / Dance / Magic / Poetry-spoken word / Other)
2. On average, how many shows do you run per month, and what's your typical audience size per show?
3. Do you organize independently, or through a talent agency / production house?
4. What tools do you currently use to manage listings, ticketing, and sales? (Excel / WhatsApp / Another platform / Other)

### **Section 2 — Listing a Show**

5. What information is mandatory for you to list a show? (Title / Cast-performers / Duration / Age rating / Language / Genre)
6. Do your shows have multiple sessions under one listing (e.g., 3 PM and 7 PM of the same play)?
7. Do you list a show as a series (multi-day run) differently from a one-off event?
8. Does your listing need approval from Platform Admin before going live, or do you publish directly?

### **Section 3 — Scheduling**

9. How far in advance do you usually list a show before the actual date?
10. What is your process when a show needs to be rescheduled or cancelled?
11. Do you need to block/hold a venue date before publicly confirming a show?

### **Section 4 — Pricing & Ticketing**

12. Do you use tiered pricing (VIP / Premium / General) or zone-based seating pricing?

- 13. Do you use dynamic pricing, early-bird pricing, or group/bulk discounts?
- 14. Do you issue complimentary or guest passes outside the paid ticketing flow?
- 15. Would a minimum-ticket-sale threshold (below which a show auto-flags for review) be useful to you?

### **Section 5 — Seating & Venue Coordination**

- 16. Is seating for your shows usually assigned/numbered or general admission?
- 17. Who provides the final seating layout — you, or the Venue Owner/Manager?

### **Section 6 — Sales & Reporting**

- 18. What sales metric do you check most often, and how frequently? (Seats sold / Revenue-to-date / Daily booking trend)
- 19. Do you need a sales breakdown by ticket tier, showtime, or promo code?
- 20. Do you need visibility into refund/cancellation rates for your shows specifically?

### **Section 7 — Promotion**

- 21. Do you run promo codes, referral discounts, or bundle offers?
- 22. How important is it for your show to appear in a "featured" or "recommended" section?

### **Section 8 — Pain Points**

- 23. What is the most time-consuming or error-prone part of managing shows today?
- 24. Is there a feature from another platform (BookMyShow, Insider, Ticketmaster) you specifically want replicated or avoided?

## **Show Organizer / Promoter — Interview Questions**

### **Opening — Understanding Context**

- 1. Tell me about the last show you organized end-to-end — walk me through it from the idea to the final settlement.
- 2. What made you choose to list it on a ticketing platform versus selling tickets yourself?

### **Listing and Scheduling**

3. Walk me through how you decide what information goes into a show listing. What do you always include, and what do you skip?
4. Have you ever had to reschedule or cancel a show at short notice? What happened to the tickets already sold, and how did you communicate the change?
5. Do you ever run into scheduling conflicts — same venue double-booked, or a performer overlapping two commitments? How do you currently catch that before it becomes a problem?

### **Pricing and Sales**

6. How do you currently decide your pricing tiers for a show, and does that pricing ever change as the date gets closer?
7. Tell me about a time complimentary passes or guest lists caused confusion with your actual ticket sales numbers.
8. What does a "successful" show look like to you in terms of the sales numbers you track, and when do you check them?

### **Venue and Seating**

9. How do you coordinate with the venue on seating layout — is that ever a source of last-minute back-and-forth?

### **Settlement and Reporting**

10. Walk me through what you need at the end of a show's run to settle up with the venue or performers. What information do you currently have to chase down manually?

### **Closing — Unmet Needs**

11. If you could automate one part of your current workflow for managing shows, what would it be and why?
12. Is there anything about how you currently run shows that a ticketing platform has never gotten right?

## **6. Venue Manager**

(Covering three possible booking-workflow designs: Option A, Option B, Option C)

### **OPTION A: FULLY IN-APP MARKETPLACE**

(Venue listed in-app, organizer requests date in-app, approval in-app, negotiation also in-app)

## **ELICITATION TECHNIQUES**

### **1. Semi-Structured Interview (Primary Technique)**

Justification: Since this option requires the venue owner to actively use in-app request/approval/negotiation features, interviews are needed to understand their expectations for workflow, control, and decision-making within the system.

### **2. Observation / Contextual Inquiry**

Justification: Observing how the venue owner currently handles multiple simultaneous booking requests helps define the in-app request-management workflow.

## **QUESTIONS TO ASK**

1. Would you be comfortable receiving and approving booking requests entirely through the app rather than by phone or email?
2. What information would you need from an organizer's request before approving it (dates, expected audience, event type, budget)?
3. Should the app allow you to negotiate price/terms with the organizer directly within the platform?
4. How should the app notify you of a new booking request (push notification, email, SMS)?
5. If two organizers request the same date, how should the app handle the conflict — first-come-first-served, manual choice, or waitlist?
6. Do you want the ability to counter-offer a different date/price within the app?
7. Once you approve a request, who should be responsible for creating the actual show listing — you or the organizer?
8. What information should be locked/finalized once you approve a booking (to prevent later disputes)?
9. Would you want an in-app record/history of all past agreements for reference?

## **OPTION B: FULLY OUTSIDE THE APP**

(Venue and organizer negotiate offline; only the finalized show is listed)

## **ELICITATION TECHNIQUES**

### **1. Semi-Structured Interview (Primary Technique)**

Justification: Since this option requires the venue owner to actively use in-app request/approval/negotiation features, interviews are needed to understand their expectations for workflow, control, and decision-making within the system.

### **2. Observation / Contextual Inquiry**

Justification: Observing how the venue owner currently handles multiple simultaneous booking requests helps define the in-app request-management workflow.

## **QUESTIONS TO ASK**

1. Once you and an organizer agree on a booking offline, what details do you expect to appear on the platform afterward?
2. Do you want any visibility into shows being listed at your venue, or is that entirely the organizer's responsibility?
3. Should your venue name/profile be verified or approved before an organizer can list a show there?
4. Would you want to be notified when a show is listed under your venue's name?
5. If a dispute arises later (wrong dates, wrong capacity), how would you expect it to be resolved, since the agreement wasn't made in-app?
6. Do you see any need for even a basic venue profile in the app (address, capacity, photos), or is that unnecessary in this model?
7. Would you want a way to report or flag a show that was listed incorrectly under your venue?

## **OPTION C: MIDDLE GROUND**

(Venue profile + availability calendar in-app; negotiation happens outside; approval workflow happens in-app)

## **ELICITATION TECHNIQUES**

### **1. Semi-Structured Interview (Primary Technique)**

Justification: Since this option requires the venue owner to actively use in-app request/approval/negotiation features, interviews are needed to understand their

expectations for workflow, control, and decision-making within the system.

## 2. Observation / Contextual Inquiry

Justification: Observing how the venue owner currently handles multiple simultaneous booking requests helps define the in-app request-management workflow.

### QUESTIONS TO ASK

1. What information about your venue would you want shown to organizers (capacity, seating layout, parking, accessibility, AV equipment)?
2. How do you currently track which dates are available or already booked?
3. Would you want to mark certain dates as blocked/unavailable in advance (maintenance, private events)?
4. When an organizer requests a date, what minimum information would you need to decide whether to approve it (event type, expected footfall)?
5. Do you want every booking request to require your manual approval, or should trusted/repeat organizers get automatic approval?
6. Once you approve a request, should the organizer be responsible for creating the actual show listing, or should you do it (e.g., for cinemas where you are also the organizer)?
7. How quickly do you need to be notified of a new booking request?
8. What should happen if you don't respond to a request within a certain time — auto-reject, auto-remind, or hold indefinitely?
9. Should approved bookings automatically lock that date on your calendar to prevent double-booking?
10. Do you need to see a history of past approvals/rejections for your venue?
11. Since pricing/contract terms are handled outside the app, is there anything about the agreement you'd still want reflected on the platform for your own records?

## 7. Platform Admin

### 1. Interview

An interview will help us directly understand the responsibilities, requirements, problems, and expectations of the platform admin. Since the admin manages users, organizers, disputes, approvals, and system issues, detailed follow-up questions will help uncover both normal and exceptional workflows.

Questions:

1. Could you explain your complete process for managing users and organizers on the platform?
2. What information do you need before approving a new organizer or event?
3. What actions should an admin be able to perform on a user or organizer account?
4. What process do you follow when an event is cancelled, postponed, or has incorrect information?
5. How do you handle customer complaints, booking disputes, and refund requests that are escalated to you?
6. What system problems or unusual activities should immediately be brought to the admin's attention?
7. What reports, statistics, or dashboard information do you need to regularly monitor the platform?
8. What problems do you currently face while managing the platform, and what would you expect the new system to improve?

## **2. JAD (Joint Application Development)**

JAD will help the team collect and validate requirements by discussing them together with the Admin and related stakeholders such as Customer Care, Event Organizers, Venue Managers, and payment-related stakeholders. It is useful for identifying dependencies and resolving conflicts between stakeholders.

Questions:

1. What should be the agreed workflow from event creation to admin approval and publication?
2. Which issues should be handled by Customer Care, and which should be escalated to the Admin?

3. Who should have the authority to approve refunds, suspend users, or remove an event?
4. What should happen when the information provided by the organizer and venue manager does not match?
5. What should happen when a payment is successful but the ticket is not generated?
6. Which admin actions should automatically notify the affected user or organizer?
7. Which requirements are essential for the first version of the system and should be included in Sprint 1?

### **3. Observation**

Observation will help us understand how the BookMyShow Admin actually performs administrative tasks. It can reveal repeated steps, difficulties, manual workarounds, and problems that the Admin may not mention during an interview.

#### **Admin Dashboard**

- What does the Admin check first when opening the dashboard — bookings, events, users, payments, or alerts?
- Does the Admin immediately notice pending approvals or important system alerts?
- Does the Admin need to open multiple sections to understand one issue?

#### **User & Organizer Management**

- How does the Admin search for a particular user or organizer?
- What information does the Admin check before taking action on an account?

#### **Event Management**

- What information does the Admin check before approving an event?
- Does the Admin need to verify information from multiple sources?
- How does the Admin handle incorrect, duplicate, or incomplete event information?
- How does the Admin modify or remove an event?

Prototyping is not selected at the initial elicitation stage because the team first needs to understand the admin's requirements and business rules before validating interface ideas.

## **8. Customer Care Agent**

### **Elicitation Technique:** Interviews

**Why:** Customer Care has specialized knowledge of customer problems, booking issues, refunds, cancellations, and support workflows. Interviews allow us to get detailed information and ask follow-up questions.

**Why not others:** Other techniques were either less suitable for obtaining detailed stakeholder-specific information, required access to an existing workflow which we do not have.

### **Interview Questions:**

1. Can you walk us through what happens when a customer contacts you with a problem, from the time you receive the complaint until it is resolved?
2. What are the different types of issues you usually receive from customers?
3. Which of these issues are the most difficult or time-consuming to resolve, and why?
4. When investigating a customer's problem, what information do you usually need from the customer or from other sources?
5. How do you verify whether the information given by a customer is correct?
6. Can you describe a situation where the status of a booking, payment, or ticket caused confusion or made the issue difficult to resolve?
7. What usually happens when you cannot resolve a customer's issue yourself?
8. Which other people or teams do you depend on when resolving customer issues, and what information do you need from them?
9. How do you currently keep track of customer issues that are still pending or need follow-up?
10. What kinds of mistakes, repeated work, or delays happen while handling customer issues?

11. Are there situations where you need to access customer, booking, payment, or event information but do not have all the information you need?

**NOTE : Although observation could reveal practical workflow details, it is difficult and potentially inappropriate to observe private customer interactions and internal computer activity. Since Customer Care can explain their workflow and real-world scenarios directly through interviews, observation does not provide enough additional benefit to justify its practical limitations.**

## 9. Payment Gateway

Since a payment gateway is a strict third-party system, we can't use normal user-focused techniques.

### 1. The Elicitation Techniques

- **Analysis of Existing Systems (Reading Documentation):** This is our main tool. We can't guess how the gateway works; we have to read their API docs, SDK guides, and compliance rules (like PCI-DSS)\*.
- **Use Cases:** Payment processing is all about different states (success, failure, refund). We need to write out the exact step-by-step flows for every possible scenario, especially the edge cases.
- **Interviews:** We won't interview the API, but we will interview the humans involved. This means talking to our internal finance/legal teams or the gateway's technical account managers to understand the business rules.

### 2. What We Are NOT Using

- **Brainstorming:** You can't just brainstorm payment security or financial protocols; you have to follow strict industry standards.
- **Joint Application Design (JAD):** We can't co-design a system with an external API that already has rigid, unchangeable rules.
- **Observation/Ethnography:** You can't sit and watch a payment gateway in its "natural habitat."

### 3. The Questions

**From Reading the Docs (Analysis of Existing Systems)**

- **Checkout Flow:** Does the gateway redirect users to their own page, or can we keep users on our app? What security levels do we need for either?
- **Server Crashes (Webhooks):** If our server crashes right when the payment goes through, will the gateway keep trying to tell us the payment succeeded?
- **Double Clicks:** Does the API have built-in protection so a user isn't charged twice if they spam the "Pay" button?
- Does the gateway support Card-on-File tokenization per RBI's CoFT mandate?  
\*\*
- **Rate Limits :** What is the gateway's API rate limit? If 50,000 people try to pay for a blockbuster movie in the same exact second, will the gateway's servers block our requests, and how do we queue them?
- **Card Offers:** If we run a promo like "20% off for HDFC Credit Cards," does the gateway API allow us to check the first 6 digits of the card to verify it's actually an HDFC card before applying the discount?
- When a user pays, does the system automatically send the organizer's cut to their bank and keep our platform commission?
- **Dynamic Currency Conversion:** If a foreigner is trying to book tickets for a major music festival in India using a US credit card, do we calculate the exchange rate on our end, or do we pass the INR amount and let the gateway's use case handle the conversion?
- **Sandbox Testing:** Does the gateway provide a "mock" environment where we can simulate severe bank network failures or expired cards so our developers can test error handling without using real money?

## From Writing Use Cases

- **The "Money Deducted, No Ticket" Error:** If the payment goes through but our database fails to generate the ticket, what exactly happens next? Do we auto-refund them, or keep checking until the ticket generates?
- **Partial Refunds:** If someone buys a movie ticket and popcorn, but cancels just the popcorn, can we refund only that amount, or do we have to cancel the whole order?

- **The UPI/Wallet Timeout:** If a user selects UPI or a mobile wallet, the system sends a prompt to their phone. What is the exact use case if they simply lock their phone and walk away? How many minutes does our system wait before marking the transaction as "Abandoned" and freeing up the seat?
- **Automated Dispute Handling (Chargebacks):** If a user claims they didn't buy a ticket and their bank reverses the charge, what is the flow to automatically send evidence (IP address, login history, and whether the QR code was scanned at the theater) back to the gateway to fight the dispute?

### From Human Interviews

- How many days does it take for the money to actually reach our company's bank account after a user buys a ticket?
- **Transaction Fees:** Who pays the 2% credit card fee? Do we eat that cost, or do we add it as a "convenience fee" for the user?
- **Gateway Downtime Penalties (SLAs):** If the payment gateway crashes on the opening night of a highly anticipated movie and we lose thousands of bookings, what are the Service Level Agreement (SLA) penalties? Do they owe us compensation for lost revenue?
- **Tax and Invoicing (GST):** Does the gateway handle the separation of the ticket cost and the GST for accounting purposes, or do they just process the gross total and leave the exact tax breakdown for our internal system to calculate?
- **API Docs** tell our developers exactly how to format digital requests (like charging a specific amount) and how the gateway will respond (like a success or failure message)

**SDK** - Instead of writing the complex API connection code from scratch, our developers can use the SDK's pre-written code libraries, ready-made checkout screens, and built-in security features.

**Compliance Rules:** These are the strict legal and industry regulations our software is forced to follow to handle money securely. A major global example is **PCI-DSS**, which dictates how card data must be encrypted and ensures we never store raw credit card numbers on our own servers.

- CoFT (Card-on-File Tokenisation) - RBI's mandate prohibiting any entity in the payment chain (merchant, payment aggregator, or gateway) except the card

issuer or card network from storing a customer's actual card number, CVV, or expiry date. The card is replaced with an encrypted, merchant-specific token instead. This is a legal requirement for Indian platforms, separate from and stricter than PCI-DSS.

## 10. Review Aggregators

### Technique 1 - Interview

**Why use this technique:** Critics carry tacit, experience-based knowledge, how they judge a film, what workflow they follow after a screening, and what would make a platform credible to their readers. A one-on-one interview allows open-ended answers and real-time follow-up, which a form cannot.

### Questions

- Walk me through your process from watching a film to publishing a finished review.
- What information do you always want recorded about a film before you start reviewing it (cast, runtime, genre, release date, director)?
- Do you rate films with a numeric/star score, or do you prefer purely descriptive judgement? What scale feels natural to you?
- How do you want to handle spoilers - a separate hidden section, a warning banner, or a spoiler-free summary followed by a detailed section?
- Would you want to attach media to a review - trailer embeds, stills, or your own photos/video?
- Do you ever revise a review after publishing (e.g., after a rewatch or director's cut)? Should the platform show an 'edited' history?
- How do you want to handle reader engagement - replying to comments, pinning a response, or staying purely one-directional?
- Do you write for a single film only, or do you also want to publish ranked lists, retrospectives, or comparison pieces?
- What would make you trust a platform enough to publish exclusively or primarily there?

- Is there anything on existing platforms (Rotten Tomatoes, Letterboxd, IMDb) that frustrates you as a critic?

## **Technique 2 - Questionnaire**

**Why use this technique:** A questionnaire scales where an interview cannot, it can reach many freelance and staff critics at once and produces quantifiable, comparable answers (ratings, preferences, yes/no choices), which is useful for prioritising features.

### **Questions**

- On a scale of 1–5, how important is a star/point rating system alongside your written text? (1 = not important, 5 = essential)
- Which format do you prefer for a review? (Short blurb / Full essay / Both, selectable per review)
- Should critique length have a minimum or maximum word count? (Yes/No - if yes, suggest a range)
- Do you want reviews broken into tagged sub-sections (Story, Direction, Performances, Cinematography, Music) or written as one continuous piece?
- Would you like a 'Verified Critic' badge to distinguish your review from a general user review? (Yes/No)
- How important is it for you to see audience/user reviews alongside your own on the same film page? (Not important / Somewhat / Very)
- Would you use a draft/schedule-publish feature to time your review with a film's release? (Yes/No)
- Do you want analytics on your reviews (views, likes, shares)? (Yes/No)
- Should the platform support embargo dates (reviews hidden until a set release time)? (Yes/No)

## **Technique 3 - Document / Content Analysis**

**Why use this technique:** Rather than inventing a review structure from nothing, established platforms have already tested and refined review formats at scale. Studying them extracts proven fields and layouts instead of guessing.

### **Sources to analyse**

- Rotten Tomatoes - Tomatometer scoring model and the 'Critics Consensus' summary format
- Letterboxd - short-form review culture, tagging, rewatch counters, list-making
- IMDb - critic-review aggregation and external link-out pattern
- Published critic reviews (newspapers, film magazines) - typical structure: verdict, story, direction, performances, technical craft, final recommendation

### **What to extract**

- Common metadata fields attached to every review (film, critic name, date, rating)
- How spoilers are marked or separated
- How a rating scale is displayed next to text (numeric, stars, percentage, fresh/rotten icon)

### **Technique 4 - Observation**

**Why use this technique:** Watching how a critic currently works, on their own blog, on social media, or on an existing platform - surfaces habits and pain points they may not think to mention in an interview or questionnaire.

### **What to observe**

- How a critic currently formats and publishes reviews (personal blog, Twitter/X thread, YouTube video, Letterboxd log)
- Whether ratings and text are duplicated inconsistently across platforms
- How readers currently engage with the critic's existing reviews (comments, shares, likes) and which platform gets the most engagement
- Any manual workaround the critic uses today that a good platform feature could replace (e.g., screenshotting a rating card to post elsewhere)